How Agents Use Tools

From a decision to an authorized action

SCAN / LEARN

THE MAIN IDEA

A tool lets an agent affect a system beyond its text response. Tool access needs permissions, input checks and review.

FOLLOW THE SYSTEM

01 INTENT

The agent decides what information it needs.

02 TOOL REQUEST

It sends structured arguments to a tool.

03 PERMISSION

The system checks whether the action is allowed.

04 RESULT

The tool returns data or confirms an action.

DECIDE → REQUEST → AUTHORIZE → EXECUTE

COMMON MISCONCEPTION

Writing “I sent the email” means the email was sent.

MORE ACCURATE

Only an authorized tool action and its confirmed result establish the change.

THREE QUESTIONS TO KEEP

PROBLEM: How can software act beyond generating words?

FAILURE: Bad permissions can cause unintended changes.

IN REAL LIFE: Reading files, checking calendars, running code.

SOLO DISCOVERY

Try alone: list three actions an assistant should ask permission before performing.